photobooth 4u

# Your booth, *no internet* needed.

The photobooth4u app for **Windows**, **Mac** and **Android tablets** (page A). The same booth as the website, installed on your laptop or tablet: it takes, saves and prints photos with **no internet**, and guests get their photo by scanning a QR over the booth Wi-Fi. **No internet is fine, but you still need a local Wi-Fi** (a router or a phone hotspot) that the laptop and guests' phones are all on. **Page 2 is a one-page quick start** for event day.

1

### Install once

Windows 10 / 11 or macOS. Activate with your code (internet needed once).

2

### Shoot offline

Designs, layouts, frames, guest screen, USB camera, silent printing and vouchers all work offline.

3

### Share on Wi-Fi

Photos save on the laptop. Guests on the booth Wi-Fi scan the QR and save their photo.


★ Quick start (page 2)

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**Which packages include the app?**

- **Monthly Offline**, **Monthly Online + Offline**, **Lifetime Offline**, **Lifetime Online + Offline**, and the **Event Pass** (24 hours) when you ask for the offline app.
- One code can activate more than one laptop: each laptop uses one of the code's **device slots**.

★ EVENT DAY

# Quick start

Do these in order. The app must be installed and activated already (pages 3 and 4).

### 1 Plug everything in

Laptop on its charger. Guest screen by HDMI, set to **Extend** (Windows: `Win + P` → Extend). Camera on a full or dummy battery. Printer on, paper loaded.

### 2 Start the booth Wi-Fi

Connect the laptop to a Wi-Fi that guests can also join. The easiest: a **pocket router** with no internet cable, or a **second phone's hotspot** (works with no data or signal). The laptop's own Windows hotspot also works, but Windows may refuse to turn it on with no connection. The app never creates a Wi-Fi itself, and a phone can't join its own hotspot, so test with another phone.

### 3 Open photobooth4u

From the Start menu (Windows) or Applications (Mac). It opens straight into the booth.

### 4 Choose the camera

**Setup → 5 Session → Camera**. Windows: **Nikon / Canon camera over USB**. Mac: **DSLR / mirrorless over USB**, then pick the camera. Or a webcam / HDMI capture card.

### 5 Check Setup and Share & start

Design, name, layout as usual. In **Share & start**, check the **event name**, **Photos on this laptop** and **Guests' phones** (it shows the address guests use). The **booth Wi-Fi name and password** are filled in for you from the Wi-Fi the laptop is on (if the password can't be read, type it there).

### 6 Choose the printers

In **Photo Session** tap 🖶 **Print settings**, pick each paper size and its printer. Printing is built in: no Print Helper, no pop-up.

### 7 Test with your phone

Tap **Wi-Fi** in the bottom bar, scan its QR with another phone to join. Take one session, scan the photo QR, tap **Save photo**. Print once.

### 8 Open the guest screen

In **Setup → 5 Session**, tap **Open guest screen**. You're ready.

**Works with no internet**

**No internet does not mean no Wi-Fi.** Connect the laptop to a router or a phone hotspot (it can have no data or signal). Guests join the same Wi-Fi to open their photo; the QR is made on the laptop either way. With the laptop on no network at all, photos still save but there is no QR for phones.

- All designs, layouts, your frames, stickers, filters, retakes, Lock booth
- Guest screen, USB camera, silent printing, vouchers

**Needs the website (internet)**

- GCash / Maya QR payments (vouchers work offline)
- Online gallery & Google Drive, My Events, tablet booths, the print station

01 · ONCE PER LAPTOP

# Install the app

We send you the installer link. Pick the one for your laptop.

WINDOWS 10 / 11

1. **Run the installer**
   Double-click **photobooth4u Setup….exe**.
2. **"Windows protected your PC"**
   Click **More info → Run anyway**. (The app isn't signed with a paid certificate yet; this is normal.)
3. **Allow admin once**
   Click **Yes**. It lets guests' phones reach the laptop on the booth Wi-Fi.

MACOS

1. **Open the .dmg**
   Use the **arm64** file for Apple Silicon (M1–M4), **x64** for Intel. Drag **photobooth4u** into **Applications**.
2. **First open: right-click → Open**
   If macOS still refuses: System Settings → Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**.
3. **Allow connections**
   When macOS asks to accept incoming network connections, click **Allow**. That's the guests' QR.

**New version?** The app tells you when one is out. Your activation, designs and photos stay. See **Updating the app** (page 6) and **Pop-ups** (page 7).

02 · ONCE PER LAPTOP

# Activate this laptop

1. **Connect to the internet (just this once)**
   Any Wi-Fi or phone hotspot.
2. **Type your code**
   The app opens on **Activate this laptop**. Type your `PB-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX` code and tap **Activate**.
3. **Done**
   The booth opens. From now on it works with no internet. The licence is tied to **this laptop**, so copying the app to another one doesn't work: activate each laptop with your code.

**No internet at all?**

Tap **No internet? Activate without internet**. The app shows a **Machine ID** (`WIN-…` / `MAC-…`).

Send us your code and that Machine ID (e.g. by text from your phone). We send back an **activation key**.

Paste it in the box and tap **Activate**.

03 · CAMERA

# Use your DSLR / mirrorless camera

Over USB the app presses the **real shutter**, so your camera's settings, focus and flash all work. Nothing extra to install.

### WINDOWS

- **Nikon**, **Canon EOS** (DSLR, M and R) and **Sony Alpha**. Built into the app.
- Plug the camera straight into the laptop with a **data** USB cable, switch it on, and pick **Nikon / Canon / Sony camera over USB**. After that it reconnects by itself.
- **Canon:** close **EOS Utility**. Older models (60D, 70D, 600D, 7D…): Menu → **Live View shoot: Enable**. Newer: **Choose USB connection app** → **Photo Import / Remote Control**. Wi-Fi off.
- **Sony:** on the camera set **USB Connection** → **PC Remote** (MENU → Setup → USB) and close Imaging Edge. If it won't connect, use its webcam mode (USB Streaming) or an HDMI capture card.

### MAC

- **Canon, Nikon, Sony, Fujifilm** and most others.
- Canon: **Photo Import / Remote Control** USB mode. Nikon: nothing to set.
- Quit **Photos**, **Image Capture** and **EOS Utility** if they open.
- Pick **DSLR / mirrorless over USB**, choose the camera, **Connect**.

### For every camera

- Mode dial on **P, A/Av, S/Tv or M**; save as **JPEG** (or RAW + JPEG).
- SD card in the camera.
- **Auto power off**: disable. Use a **dummy battery** for long events.
- Webcams and HDMI capture cards work too (no flash).

04 · PRINTING

# Printing

### 1 Set up the printer once

Install its driver and do one test print from the laptop. In the printer's own preferences set the **paper size**, **borderless** and, for 2×6 strips, **cut**.

### 2 Choose a printer per paper size

In **Photo Session** → 🖶 **Print settings**, pick a printer for each size (e.g. 4R on one, 2×6 strips on another). The app remembers it.

### 3 Auto-print

Print once to test, then tick **Auto-print every session**. Prints go straight to the printer, no pop-up.

### Print an earlier photo

### Good to know

- The **Print Helper** isn't needed: it's built into the app.
- Same printer for two sizes? Add it to the laptop **twice**, each with its own defaults and name.
- The paper sizes in your package appear in Print settings.
- **Thermal receipt printers** (80 / 58 mm): see the Thermal printing guide at photobooth4u.netlify.app/how-to-print-thermal/

05 · SHARING WITHOUT INTERNET

# Guests' photos over Wi-Fi

Every photo is saved on the laptop. The laptop also serves a small photo page on the booth Wi-Fi, so guests save their photo straight to their phone. Nothing is uploaded.

Guest joins the booth Wi-Fi → Scans their photo QR → Taps Save photo

### 1 One Wi-Fi for laptop and guests

A small router at the booth (no SIM or internet needed) or a second phone's hotspot (no data needed). Venue Wi-Fi works too, if guests' phones can join it. The laptop's own Windows hotspot may refuse to start with no connection, so a router or phone hotspot is more reliable. The laptop must be connected to it, or there is no photo QR.

### 2 Check Share & start

**Guests' phones** shows the address guests open, with a ✓. If it says the laptop isn't on a Wi-Fi network, connect it first.

### 3 Join Wi-Fi QR

Under **Booth Wi-Fi for guests** the app fills in the name and password of the Wi-Fi the laptop is on (tap **Use current Wi-Fi** to read it again; type the password if it can't be read; on a Mac, allow the Keychain request). The **Wi-Fi** button in the bottom bar, beside **Extras** and **Lock booth**, shows the same QR on the booth screen: guests scan it to join, then scan their photo QR.

### 4 Print the Wi-Fi sign

Tap **Download WIFI QR Sign** and print it (A5 or bigger) for the booth table. After each session guests get their **photo** and **GIF** QR codes; the **All photos** QR is behind the **All photos** button in the bottom bar.

#### Photos on this laptop

Saved in `Pictures/photobooth4u/<event name>/`, one file per session.

**Open photos folder** and **Change folder** are in **Share & start**. Copy the folder to a USB drive or upload it for your client after the event.

#### Guests can't open the photo?

Their phone must be on the **same Wi-Fi** as the laptop (phones sometimes switch back to mobile data: turn data off, or join the Wi-Fi again). The guests' page works until the app is closed.

GUEST PAYMENTS OFFLINE

## Vouchers

QR payments (GCash, Maya) need the internet. **Vouchers** work offline: set **Guest payment** to **Vouchers** in **Setup → 5 Session**, sell the printed codes at the table, and each code works once.

06 · NEW VERSIONS

# Updating the app

When a new version is out, a bar appears at the top of the booth. It needs **internet**, so update **before the event** at home or on any Wi-Fi, never on event day. Your activation, designs and photos stay.

WINDOWS

1. **The bar says "Version … is ready"**
   The app downloads it by itself in the background. You can keep using the booth.
2. **Tap Restart now**
   **Later** is fine too: it then installs when you close the app.
3. **Click Yes when Windows asks**
   "Do you want to allow this app to make changes?" is normal. Click **Yes**.
4. **Done**
   The app closes and opens again by itself on the new version.

MACOS

1. **The bar says "Version … is out"**
   Tap **Download**. It shows the progress; keep using the booth meanwhile.
2. **A window opens by itself**
   The new version arrives in your **Downloads** folder as a disk image. **Show it again** reopens the window.
3. **Drag it into Applications**
   Drag **photobooth4u** onto **Applications** and choose **Replace**.
4. **Quit the app and open it again**
   The bar is gone and you're on the new version.

**Laptop with no internet?** It keeps working as it is. To update, connect it to any Wi-Fi or phone hotspot once, open the app, and the bar appears within a few hours (or straight away after you close and reopen the app).

A · ANDROID TABLET

# The Android tablet app

The same offline booth as a tablet app (Android 7.0 or newer). Photos save on the tablet and guests get theirs over the booth Wi-Fi. Your code must include the **offline app** (Offline or Online + Offline packages).

1. ### Download the app

   On the tablet open **photobooth4u.netlify.app/downloads** and tap **Download APK**. Open the file; when Android asks, allow **Install unknown apps** for your browser, then **Install**.

2. ### Activate with your code

   Open photobooth4u and type your access code on the **Activate this tablet** screen. It needs internet this one time.

3. ### Set up as usual

   Design, layout and Share & start work like the laptop app. The tablet's camera is used. Guests scan the photo QR on the booth Wi-Fi.

4. ### Print on Bluetooth thermal printers

   Pair the printer in **Android Settings → Bluetooth** (PIN 0000 or 1234), then in the booth pick **Receipt 80 mm** or **58 mm**, enable **Bluetooth thermal receipt printer**, tap **Connect** and **Test print**. For HiTi / DNP photo printers use the laptop app.

**New versions**

When you open the app with internet, it can show **New version available**. Tap **Update** between events: the new file downloads, then Android asks to install it over the old app. Your activation stays.

**"App not installed"?**

Android only installs an update signed by the same key. If it refuses, **copy your photos off the tablet first**, uninstall photobooth4u, install the new file and enter your code again.

**Not in the Android app**

GCash / Maya QR payments (vouchers work), the online gallery and My Events. Use the website booth for those.

07 · POP-UPS YOU MAY SEE

# Pop-ups: what to click

The app isn't signed with a paid certificate yet, so Windows and macOS ask a few extra questions the first time. These are normal. Here is what to answer.

| WINDOWS POP-UP | WHAT TO DO |
|---|---|
| **"Windows protected your PC"** | Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Seen when you first run the installer. |
| **"Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?"** | Click **Yes**. Seen when installing and updating. It lets guests' phones reach the laptop on the booth Wi-Fi. |
| **Windows Defender Firewall asks to allow photobooth4u** | Tick **Private networks** and click **Allow access**, so guests' phones can open their photo. |

| MAC POP-UP | WHAT TO DO |
|---|---|
| **"photobooth4u can't be opened" / "Apple cannot check it"** | Right-click the app and choose **Open**, then **Open** again. Or System Settings → Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**. |
| **"photobooth4u wants to use your confidential information stored in 'photobooth4u Safe Storage' in your keychain"** | It's the app's own saved settings. Type your **Mac login password** and click **Always Allow** (it won't ask again). It may ask again after an update. |
| **"Do you want the application to accept incoming network connections?"** | Click **Allow**. That is what lets guests scan the QR and open their photo. |
| **"An item named photobooth4u already exists"** | Click **Replace** (while updating). |

**A pop-up that isn't here?** Don't guess: take a photo or screenshot of it and message us (Facebook Messenger, **m.me/roktetnachi**). Never type your code or password into a window that appeared from a website or a message.

08 · YOUR LICENCE

# Your licence

### How long it works

- **Lifetime:** renews by itself whenever the laptop has internet. With no internet it keeps working for **75 days + 30 days' grace**, then asks to connect once.
- **6-Month Pass / per-event:** works until the code's end date, with or without internet.
- Changes we make for your code (print sizes, vouchers, retakes…) arrive when the app starts with internet, or tap **Check for changes** in Share & start.

### New laptop or reinstalling?

- On the old laptop: **Share & start → Deactivate this laptop**. That frees its device slot.
- Activate the new laptop with the same code.
- Old laptop lost or broken? Message us and we free its slot.
- **Don't set the laptop's clock back:** the booth locks until the clock is right again.

09 · TROUBLESHOOTING

# If something goes wrong

| PROBLEM | TRY THIS |
|---|---|
| **"Windows protected your PC" / Mac won't open it** | Windows: **More info → Run anyway**. Mac: right-click the app → **Open**, or Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**. |
| **Activation says no free device slot** | Deactivate an old laptop (Share & start), or message us to free one. |
| **Camera not found (Windows)** | Data USB cable straight into the laptop, camera on. Close EOS Utility / NX Studio and any "Import photos" window. Unplug, replug. |
| **Canon: no live view** | Menu → **Live View shoot: Enable**, close the menu, mode dial on P, Tv, Av or M. |
| **Camera "couldn't focus"** | Point it at something with detail, add light, or set the lens to **MF**. |
| **Guests' QR doesn't open** | Phone and laptop on the same Wi-Fi; phone's mobile data off. Mac: allow incoming connections (System Settings → Network → Firewall). |
| **Prints show a pop-up or go to the wrong printer** | Print settings → choose the printer for that size again. |
| **"Connect to the internet to continue"** | Lifetime check-in is due: connect once to any internet and reopen the app. |
| **The booth is locked** | The code ended, the laptop was removed, or the clock was changed. Check the date and time, then message us. |

## Need help? Message us.

We're on Facebook Messenger: **m.me/roktetnachi**

Message us